

We have a #design problem. Help us solve it

We built #ChaturAI to help young people find #apprenticeships. We did not build it to hold the rest of their lives. Now we're facing a situation I don't have the answer to, so I'm bringing it to you.

#Chatur and #MahaChatur are our #AI tools on #WhatsApp. They help young people, most from small towns and villages, many using AI for the first time — find and register for apprenticeships. The narrow job, we've gotten good at. We now have around 30,000 #users. On the happy side, registration that once felt complex now happens in seconds. Our internal dashboard shows 90% registrations completing in under 11 seconds.

But people are not tasks.

Recently, a user came to #Chatur with a deeply #personal issue. *The conversation moved from heartbreak to language that indicated possible self-harm risk.* A career tool isn't built to hold that. And yet walking away isn't something I can live with.

So this is a #design problem, and I'd like your help thinking it through. As far as I can see, there are three doors:

A. Stay in our lane and refer out — but handing a number to someone in crisis usually means the call never gets made.

B. Build some support capability in-house — but we're not counsellors, and shouldn't pretend to be.

C. Bring expert partners onto Chatur itself — but how do you design a handoff that actually holds, instead of a drop-off?

If you've sat with a harder version of this - in #MentalHealth, helplines, safeguarding, product, AI - I want to hear how you did it. Tell me what we're missing. We'll be reading every reply.

#ResponsibleAI #AIforPublicGood #PublicSystems #MentalHealth

Shipra Srivastava | RightWalk Foundation | Ujwal Thakar | Shridhar Sethuram | Hari TN |
the^delta |